

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1031

By Crowe

A RESOLUTION to honor the fourteen fallen veterans of Happy Valley High School.

WHEREAS, the contributions and sacrifices of the Tennesseans who have served in the U.S. Armed Forces have been vital in maintaining our freedoms and our way of life, and we will never forget the ultimate sacrifice made by many of these veterans while defending our country; and

WHEREAS, among the tens of millions of Americans who have served in the Armed Forces of the United States from the American Revolution to the present, fourteen Happy Valley High School alumni sacrificed their lives in either World War II, the Korean War, the Vietnam War, or Operation Desert Storm; and

WHEREAS, Cpl. James David Bowers, Class of 1966, was killed in action while serving with the Golf Company, 2nd Battalion, 3rd Regiment, 3rd Marine Division, in Vietnam and was awarded a Purple Heart, Marine Corps Presidential Unit Citation, and Vietnam Gallantry Cross; and

WHEREAS, S2c William Vane Campbell (Purple Heart), Class of 1939, was the first Carter Countian killed in World War II, losing his life during the attack on Pearl Harbor while onboard the battleship USS *Oklahoma*; and

WHEREAS, Pvt. Charles Wayne Clamon (Purple Heart), Class of 1943, was killed in action on the Pacific Island of Tinian while fighting with the 8th Marines, 2nd Marine Division, to take "Hell's Half Acre," a strategic point for Allied Forces; and

WHEREAS, SSG. Billy Joe Ellis (Purple Heart), Class of 1966, was declared missing in action from Company D, 2nd Battalion, 12th Cavalry Regiment, 1st Cavalry Division, in Vietnam after his unit came under heavy night attack; and

WHEREAS, Cpt. Daniel Eugene Graybeal, Class of 1983, was engaged in a rescue mission as a Medevac Helicopter Pilot with the 507th Medical Company Air Ambulance, 13th Corps Support Command, when he was shot down by Iraqi forces during the final hours of Desert Storm; he was awarded the Purple Heart and Air Assault Badge; and

WHEREAS, SSG. Larry Jerome Lyons, Class of 1959, was serving as a heavy equipment operator in C Company, 87th Engineering Group, 18th Engineering Brigade, when he was killed in action during a mortar attack on an airbase in Vietnam; he was awarded a Vietnam Gallantry Cross, Purple Heart, and Bronze Star; and

WHEREAS, Pvt. Joe Pete McKeehan, Class of 1946, was killed in action during the Korean War while assigned to 38th Infantry Regiment, 2nd Infantry Division, and was awarded a Purple Heart and Korean Presidential Unit Citation; and

WHEREAS, S2c. Louis Henry McKeehan, Class of 1944, was declared "Missing In Action, Lost at Sea" after a violent typhoon sank the USS *Hull* in the Philippine Sea during World War II; he was the youngest Happy Valley alumnus to lose his life during wartime; and

WHEREAS, Pvt. Tommy Edwin McKeehan (Purple Heart), Class 1944, was killed in the "Omaha Beach" landing during the D-Day invasion as a member of Company L of the 115th Infantry Regiment, 29th Infantry Division; and

WHEREAS, SSG. Ira Meredith (Purple Heart), Class of 1932, was the oldest Happy Valley alumnus killed and the first Carter Countian to earn the Distinguished Service Cross in World War II; a member of Company L, 8th Infantry Regiment, 4th Infantry Division, he was killed when he courageously charged an enemy machine gun position during the "Utah Beach" landing of the D-Day invasion; and

WHEREAS, SP4 Gary Dalton Murray, Class of 1964, served as a Medic in the HHC, 3rd Battalion, 12th Infantry, 4th Infantry Division in Vietnam; he was killed while coming to the aid of wounded soldiers and was awarded a Purple Heart and a Bronze Star with a "V" for Valor; and

WHEREAS, SSG. Raymond Francis Range, Class of 1934, was the laboratory director for the 106th General Hospital of the Army Air Forces in England, when he lost his life during World War II; and

WHEREAS, PO1 Frank Eugene Verran, Class of 1936, served as an Aviation Radio Man, 1st Class during World War II; he was declared missing in action when the Navy Martin Mariner Flying Boat airplane he was aboard crashed into the Atlantic Ocean off Long Island during an anti-submarine training exercise; and

WHEREAS, LCpl. Harold Wendell Wilson, Class of 1963, was killed in action by enemy small arms fire in Vietnam while assigned to Company K, 3rd Battalion, 7th Marines, 1st Marine Division, III MA, and was awarded a Purple Heart and Gallantry Cross with Palm Medal; and

WHEREAS, while no measure of commendation could properly express our gratitude for the service of these fourteen men, it is incumbent upon us to honor their memories to the full extent of our abilities, today and every day; and

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the fourteen fallen veterans who were alumni of Happy Valley High School and pay tribute to their service and their ultimate sacrifice during war time for the United States and their fellow Americans.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.